



SAFETY TOOLBOX TALK

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Topic:			Falls from Height		

This briefing is not intended to tell you how to do your jobs, it is designed to help keep you safe. We want everybody to be able to return home safely to their family and friends at the end of each day.

Who needs fall protection equipment?

If you said workers building bridges or cleaning office tower windows you would be right.

But what about all the workers who work at lesser heights, just a few feet off the ground? They should also beprotected from falls - which can be every bit as fatal.

Consider your work area. Are there locations from which someone could fall? What sort of protection is in place to prevent a fall? And is there equipment to stop a fall?

Fall protection equipment is broadly divided into two categories:

Fall prevention equipment. Guardrails and coverings at floor openings and safety-interlock gates on elevated platforms are designed to prevent falls. A body harness worn by the worker canalso be used to tether him to an area away from the fall hazard.

Fall arrest equipment is designed to save the worker if he falls. He may wear Personal Protective Equipment consisting of a body harness and lanyard attached to a lifeline or an anchor point. Or a net slung below the work area may protect him.

The law says that a worker must be protected if he is exposed to a potential fall that could cause and injury,even if they are working below ground level.

Check these areas:

Do employees ever have to climb on top of vehicles, to unload tankers, remove load strapping, paintor do other maintenance?

Does anyone ever go to the roof? Do maintenance workers service the air conditioner up there? What is the potential for falls?

Do you ever do painting of the facility during slow work periods? Are scaffolds built safely according to regulations?

Floor openings created by construction work must always be properly barricaded and securelycovered. Catwalks over machinery and process equipment must be regularly inspected and maintained.

Safety regulations are in place to prevent falls from heights. Be sure to follow these rules to the letter.

You know a Fall Hazard when you see one, so report it to ensure it gets fixed.

Discussion Points

How do you protect yourself against a fall from working at height?

What should be identified before any work at height begins?